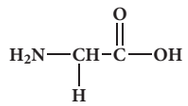
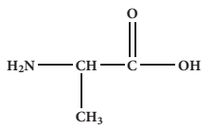
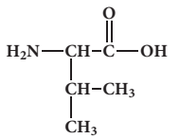
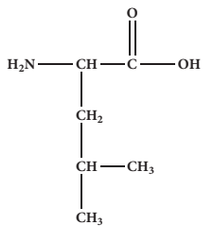
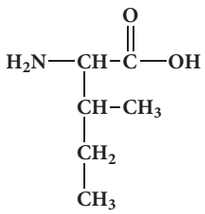
3.2.3 Amino acids with basic side chains

At physiologic pH the amino acids arginine and lysine are positively charged due to the ionization of their side chains. The side chain of the amino acid histidine acts as a weak base and in proteins histidine is either neutral or basic depending on the chemical environment.

Table 3.1 Properties of Amino acids

S. NO	Amino Acid name	Three letter code	One letter code	Structure of Amino acid	Type
1.	Glycine	GLY	G	 Glycine (Gly)	Non-polar
2.	Alanine	ALA	A	 Alanine (Ala)	Non-polar, Hydrophobic
3.	Valine	VAL	V	 Valine (Val)	Non-polar, Hydrophobic
4.	Leucine	LEU	L	 Leucine (Leu)	Non-polar, Hydrophobic
5.	Isoleucine	ILE	I	 Isoleucine (Ile)	Non-polar, Hydrophobic

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